Calix

MODULE 1

CHAPTER 5

Activate Your AI Leadership Team

AI will soon be built into the same Calix Cloud applications, Engagement Cloud, Operations Cloud, and Service Cloud, that already run your core business.

When that happens, you'll have access to a complete AI enabled platform from a trusted source ready to leverage to incorporate AI into your core business processes. To make the three initial decisions referenced in Chapter 2, you will need an AI leadership team to determine how these new capabilities will be used day-to-day: which problems to solve first, how to measure results, and how to keep adoption consistent across teams. Additionally, your AI leadership team need to establish an AI governance policy as you begin your AI adoption journey.

What You'll Learn

- Why setting out an explicit AI leadership team is vital
- What roles are key to that team
- The various levels of complexity that exist in implementing AI
- How to govern the risk AI introduces at each of those levels
- How to create an AI governance policy that fits the unique needs of your company

Platforms Provide Power; Leadership Decides Where to Focus It

An AI leadership team keeps things organized and intentional. It ensures every AI effort supports clear business goals, saving time, improving the subscriber experience, or easing the load on staff, instead of becoming a one-off experiment.

Because governance is a leadership responsibility, this group also defines how AI tools will be tested, approved, and introduced to employees across the company. They set practical boundaries for what should stay in human hands versus what can be automated, share what's working, and build confidence through communication and hands-on learning. Resources like Calix U's AI-Empowered Workforce Evolution program make that curated rollout of AI easier to scale.

When Forming Your Team

- **Start small.** Even two or three people can drive meaningful progress.
- **Choose cross-functional members.** Include voices from operations, marketing, and customer service.
- **Assign clear roles.** Define who leads, who coordinates, and who reports back.

Key Roles to Consider

👤

Executive Sponsor

Champions AI at the leadership level and secures resources.

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AI Lead

Coordinates day-to-day efforts and tracks progress.

💡

Change Champion

🛡️

Governance Owner

Drives adoption and addresses team concerns.

Ensures ethical, transparent, and responsible use.

Create Your AI Governance Policy

Strengthen What Exists — Extend Where Needed

Your governance policy for AI is one of the key decisions your AI leadership team needs to make as you begin your AI adoption journey.

For most communication service providers, the AI most used by its employees will appear inside the trusted platforms they already count on, e.g. Microsoft 365, Salesforce, Calix Cloud. These platforms come with enterprise-grade security, privacy, and compliance controls baked in. That means governance isn't something new to build. It's something to review, reinforce, and communicate.

However, in the situations in which a broadband provider is aggregating data for analytics or introducing stand-alone AI tools or home-grown applications that operate outside those environments, different levels of work and oversight are required. Each level of complexity raises the risk level, requiring deeper governance measures.

AI Location	Examples	What You Govern	Complexity Level	Governance Approach
Trusted Applications with Built-In AI	Workday, Salesforce Einstein, ServiceNow AI	Usage configuration, access, enablement decisions	**Low – Medium**	Policy + Procurement Controls
AI in Data & Analytics Platforms	Snowflake Cortex, Databricks Models	Training Data, performance, Explainability	**Medium – High**	Model Governance + Data Governance Integration
Custom / LLM / Agent AI	OpenAI API, Azure OpenAI, Internal Chatbots, RAG Systems	Prompts, model outputs, hallucination behavior, safety	**Highest**	Full AI Risk Management + Human Oversight

> It's very important to recognize that not all AI requires heavy governance. The most important thing is to govern the risks AI introduces, not the technology itself.

Apply Governance Differently Based on Where the AI Lives

Trusted Applications with Built-In AI LOW COMPLEXITY

Modern examples: Workday, Salesforce, and ServiceNow

When you're working with AI embedded in vendor applications, you rarely govern the model itself. Instead, you are governing how your company uses it. This significantly lowers the inherent risk and complexity of governance. In this case your controls are:

- ✓ Contract Language
- ✓ Enable/Disable features by policy
- ✓ Access rights (which roles see AI suggestions)
- ✓ Documentation of business impact
- ✓ Audit logs for decisions influenced by AI
- ✓ Acceptable Use Policies

AI built into enterprise applications should fit within existing application governance practices. It is wise to ensure contractual language addresses the need to protect your company's data, including the prompts submitted to AI systems and the responses to those prompts. You should ensure accurate access controls are in place as many employees have a tendency to overshare content, and AI may surface or reference confidential information if it isn't protected to begin with.

Educate your employees on responsible use of AI, e.g., that they are ultimately responsible for the output they share whether they use AI or not. Update your company's Acceptable Use Policies if needed to ensure employees know AI is there to assist, but ultimately they are responsible for its proper use.

> **Think of it this way:** Treat AI like the power tools you find around your garage – safe if used correctly, dangerous if mishandled! As long as employees know their accountability, no committees or bureaucracy is required, just explicit human accountability.

AI in the Data / Analytics Layer MEDIUM COMPLEXITY

Modern examples: Snowflake Cortex and Databricks

Where you are aggregating data from multiple sources for analytics, your risk and complexity grows because this is where insights start influencing decisions. You are no longer relying on access controls on source systems like Salesforce or Microsoft 365, you now have to consider additional controls:

- ✓ Data handling standards DATA GOVERNANCE
- ✓ Privacy Assessments DATA GOVERNANCE
- ✓ Data lineage DATA GOVERNANCE
- ✓ AI-generated insights should require peer reviews AI GOVERNANCE
- ✓ Automated Decisions must be manually approved AI GOVERNANCE
- ✓ Fairness and bias checks AI GOVERNANCE

This is where data governance and AI governance must be integrated. Where AI output is used to drive decisions, you require continuous monitoring and explainability. For anything that changes behavior broadly (pricing, staffing, customer targeting), ensure someone accountable carefully reviews it.

Custom AI / LLM / Agent Systems HIGH COMPLEXITY

Modern examples: OpenAI, RAG, and internal copilots

When you are planning to build custom AI capabilities, here again the risk grows along with the need to apply the full governance stack because outputs can vary by prompt and context, models may hallucinate, and model behavior can change over time. With these challenges come additional control requirements:

- ✓ Prompt filtering / safety guardrails
- ✓ Human-in-the-loop for high-impact actions
- ✓ Output logging and traceability
- ✓ Clear rollback and shutdown procedures

This is your highest risk, and therefore, strictest governance situation. In this case, it is recommended that you carefully inventory and manage each AI instance along with its interactions with other agents and tools.

Chapter Takeaway

As your first act in adopting AI, set out a specific leadership team with defined roles to lead your company on the journey to successful AI adoption.

AI governance is an extension of existing governance, applied based on where AI is located and its business impact. For most broadband providers, focus on governing the decisions AI influences and mitigate risk by leaning on vendors like Calix who lower your risk profile.